

Web Applications

TypeScript

Suheil Hammoud

■ TypeScript for JavaScript Programmers

TypeScript extends JavaScript by adding a powerful type system. It catches errors early, making your code more reliable.

- Static typing helps detect bugs during development
- Improves IDE support (autocomplete, refactoring)
- Scales better for large applications

The Basics

- TypeScript is a superset of JavaScript
- You can gradually adopt it
- Compiles to plain JavaScript

```
let message: string = "Hello";  
let count: number = 10;
```

- Types are erased at runtime

Everyday Types

Common types used daily:

- `string`, `number`, `boolean`
- Arrays: `string[]`
- Objects: `{}`

```
let age: number = 30;  
let isAdmin: boolean = true;  
let names: string[] = ["Alice", "Bob"];
```

- These are the building blocks of all programs

Types by Inference

TypeScript infers types automatically.

```
let helloWorld = "Hello World";
```

- Reduces verbosity
- Keeps code readable
- Still provides full type safety

Defining Types

When inference is not enough, define types explicitly.

- Improves readability
- Documents intent

```
const user = {  
  name: "Hayes",  
  id: 0,  
};
```

```
interface User {  
  name: string;  
  id: number;  
}  
  
const user: User = {  
  name: "Hayes",  
  id: 0,  
};
```

■ TypeScript Types Overview

TypeScript provides a rich type system for safer and more expressive code.

- Types describe the shape of data
- Enable better tooling and error checking
- Useful for large-scale applications

■ Type Aliases

Type aliases give names to types:

```
type UserID = string;  
type Point = { x: number; y: number };
```

- Improves readability
- Reusable across code

Type vs Interface

Both describe shapes, but differ:

- `interface` → best for object shapes
- `type` → more flexible

```
interface User {  
    name: string;  
}  
  
type Admin = User & { role: string };
```

- Types support unions, intersections, and more

Object Literal Types

Define object structures inline:

```
type Product = {  
  name: string;  
  price: number;  
  inStock?: boolean;  
};
```

- Optional fields with `?`
- Strong structure enforcement

Function Types

Describe callable structures:

```
type Callback = (value: string) => void;
```

- Can define parameters and return types

Union Types

A value can be one of many types:

```
type Size = "small" | "medium" | "large";
```

- Useful for fixed sets of values

Intersection Types

Combine multiple types:

```
type A = { x: number };  
type B = { y: number };  
  
type C = A & B; // { x: number, y: number }
```

- Merges properties

Tuple Types

Fixed-length arrays with known types:

```
type Data = [number, string];
```

- Each position has a specific type

Type from Value

Extract types from existing values:

```
const data = { name: "Alice" };  
  
type Data = typeof data;
```

- Keeps types in sync with values

Indexed Access Types

Access part of a type:

```
type Response = { data: string };  
type Data = Response["data"];
```

- Extracts nested types

Conditional Types

Types with logic:

```
type IsString<T> = T extends string ? true : false;
```

- Works like `if` in type system

Template Literal Types

Build types using strings:

```
type Lang = "en" | "pt";  
type Section = "header" | "footer";  
  
type IDs = `${Lang}_${Section}_id`;
```

- Combines string unions

Mapped Types

Transform existing types:

```
type Subscriber<T> = {  
  [K in keyof T]: (value: T[K]) => void;  
};
```

- Iterates over properties
- Creates new structures

Utility Types

- Create new types from existing ones
- Built-in helpers:
 - `Partial<T>`
 - `Readonly<T>`
 - `Pick<T, K>`
 - `ReturnType<T>`
- Simplify common patterns
- Avoid duplication
- Improve maintainability

Partial Type

```
type User = { name: string; age: number; };  
type PartialUser = Partial<User>;
```

Constructs a type with all properties of 'User' to optional

Readonly Type

```
type Point = { x: number; y: number };  
type ReadonlyPoint = Readonly<Point>;
```

Constructs a type with all properties of 'Point' set to readonly

Keyof Type Operator

```
type User = { name: string; id: number };  
type Keys = keyof User;
```

- Produces union of keys

typeof Type Operator

```
const user = { name: "Alice" };  
type UserType = typeof user;
```

- Extracts type from value

Pick from type

Syntax: `Pick<OriginalType, 'key1' | 'key2'>`

```
interface User {  
  id: number;  
  name: string;  
  email: string;  
  password: string;  
}  
  
// Pick only public fields, exclude password one  
type PublicUser = Pick<User, 'id' | 'name' | 'email'>;
```

Return Type Extraction

Get function return types:

```
function createUser() {  
  return { name: "Alice" };  
}  
  
type User = ReturnType<typeof createUser>;
```


■ TypeScript Classes Overview

TypeScript builds on JavaScript classes with additional type features.

- Adds type safety to class members
- Includes compile-time checks
- Keeps JavaScript runtime behavior

■ Defining a Class

Basic class syntax:

```
class User {  
  name: string;  
  id: number;  
  
  constructor(id: number, name: string) {  
    this.id = id;  
    this.name = name;  
  }  
}
```

- Constructor initializes fields
- Types are enforced during development

Creating Instances

Create objects using `new`:

```
const user = new User(1, "Alice");
```

- `new` calls the constructor
- Returns an instance of the class

Access Modifiers

Control visibility of properties:

- `public` (default)
- `private`
- `protected`

```
class Account {  
    private balance: number;  
  
    constructor(balance: number) {  
        this.balance = balance;  
    }  
}
```

- `private` is only checked at compile time

private vs #private

Two types of privacy:

```
class Example {  
  private x = 1;    // Type-only  
  #y = 2;           // Runtime private  
}
```

- `private` → TypeScript only
- `#private` → Enforced in JavaScript runtime

Methods and this

The value of `this` depends on how a function is called.

```
class Counter {  
  count = 0;  
  
  increment() {  
    this.count++;  
  }  
}
```

- Use arrow functions or `bind` to fix `this`

```
increment = () => this.count++;
```

Getters and Setters

Control access to properties:

```
class User {  
    private _name: string = "";  
  
    get name() {  
        return this._name;  
    }  
  
    set name(value: string) {  
        this._name = value;  
    }  
}
```

- Encapsulates logic
- Provides controlled access

Static Members

Belong to the class, not instances:

```
class Config {  
    static version = "1.0";  
  
    static getVersion() {  
        return Config.version;  
    }  
}
```

- Access using class name
- Shared across all instances

Parameter Properties

Shortcut for defining and initializing fields:

```
class Point {  
    constructor(public x: number, public y: number) {}  
}
```

- Automatically creates and assigns properties

Inheritance

Extend classes using `extends`:

```
class Animal {  
  speak() {  
    console.log("Some sound");  
  }  
}  
  
class Dog extends Animal {  
  speak() {  
    console.log("Bark");  
  }  
}
```

- Enables code reuse
- Supports method overriding

■ Implements

Ensure a class follows a structure:

```
interface Serializable {  
    serialize(): string;  
}  
  
class User implements Serializable {  
    serialize() {  
        return "user";  
    }  
}
```

- Enforces contracts

Abstract Classes

Cannot be instantiated directly:

```
abstract class Animal {  
    abstract getName(): string;  
  
    printName() {  
        console.log("Hello " + this.getName());  
    }  
}
```

- Used as base classes
- Can include abstract methods

Generics in Classes

Reusable type-safe classes:

```
class Box<T> {  
    contents: T;  
  
    constructor(value: T) {  
        this.contents = value;  
    }  
}
```

- Works with different types
- Improves flexibility

Structural Type System

- TypeScript checks structure, not name

```
interface Point {  
  x: number;  
  y: number;  
}  
  
function logPoint(p: Point) {  
  console.log(`${p.x}, ${p.y}`);  
}  
  
const point = { x: 12, y: 26 };  
logPoint(point);
```

Shape Matching

```
const point3 = { x: 12, y: 26, z: 89 };  
logPoint(point3);  
  
const color = { hex: "#187ABF" };  
logPoint(color); // Error
```

Classes and Structural Typing

```
class VirtualPoint {  
  x:number; y: number;  
  
  constructor(x: number, y: number) {  
    this.x = x;  
    this.y = y;  
  }  
}  
  
const newVPoint = new VirtualPoint(13, 56);  
logPoint(newVPoint);
```


Decorators

Add metadata to classes and members:

```
@sealed  
class User {  
  name: string;  
}
```

- Used for frameworks and advanced patterns.
- Common Use Cases: Logging, Validation, Caching, Serialization, etc.
- Require "experimentalDecorators": true in tsconfig.json.

References

- <https://www.typescriptlang.org/docs/handbook>